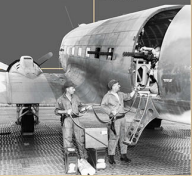


1965			1966			1967		
FEBRUARY 7 In response to an attack by the Viet Cong on the US base at Pleiku, air strikes are launched against targets in North Vietnam in Operation Flaming Dart.	MARCH 8 US Marines go ashore at Da Nang, the first American combat troops to enter Vietnam.	JUNE 14 General Nguyen Van Thieu is elected president of South Vietnam. His running mate, Air Marshal Nguyen Cao Ky, becomes prime minister.		MAY 12-13 Students in Chicago and New York City occupy university buildings to protest against the Vietnam draft.	AUGUST 18 Austrian troops fight the Viet Cong in the battle of Long Tan, the most famous Australian engagement of the war.	OCTOBER 14 US Defense Secretary Robert McNamara makes a famous pessimistic assessment of lack of progress toward winning the war.	JANUARY 6-15 US and South Vietnamese Marines carry out a major amphibious operation in the Mekong Delta.	
FEBRUARY 26 The first South Korean troops arrive in South Vietnam.	APRIL 4 Bell UH-1H Thunderbells are shot down by North Vietnamese MiG-17 fighters over North Vietnam.	JULY 24 North Vietnamese anti-aircraft defenses make their first use of Soviet-style surface-to-air missiles (SAMs).		JUNE 1 Buddhist demonstrations, opposed to South Vietnam's military government, storm the US consulate in Hanoi.		FIRST MG 21-1 arrive in Vietnam, August 1966		
	JULY 28 President Johnson announces that 50,000 more ground troops are to be sent to Vietnam—meaning an increase in the draft to 35,000 per month.	NOVEMBER 2 American Quaker Norman Morrison burns himself to death in front of the Pentagon in protest of the Vietnam War.	JAN 28-MAR 6 US, Korean, and ARVN troops carry out a "search-and-destroy" operation in Binh Dinh province.	JUNE 29-30 American aircraft attack targets in Hanoi and Haiphong—often precision-guided bombs for bombing raids.	AUG 1966-MAR 1967 US Third Marine Division leads NVA attempts to cross the DMZ into Quang Tri province during Operation Puma.	OCTOBER 24-25 President Johnson meets Asian leaders, including President Thieu, at the Manila Conference, where they discuss a way to end the war in Vietnam.	JANUARY 8-26 In Operation Cedar Falls, the US carries out a large-scale search-and-destroy action to clear the Viet Cong from their "Iron Triangle" stronghold north of Saigon.	CEAR FALLS , January 1967
	NOVEMBER 14-17 US Air Cavalry fight North Vietnamese troops in the Battle of Ia Drang. A battalion of the Cavalry is ambushed by NVA forces at landing zone X-Ray.	JANUARY 31 US bombing of North Vietnam in Operation Rolling Thunder resumes after a 31-day pause.	JULY 15-AUGUST 3 US Marines repel a substantial incursion by NVA troops across the DMZ into Quang Tri province.	SEPT 14-NOV 24 In Operation Abolition, the US 196th Light Infantry Brigade operations search-and-destroy units through Viet Cong base areas in Tay Ninh province, bordering Cambodia.	DECEMBER 31 At the year end there are 288,400 US troops in Vietnam. The US death toll for 1966 is 6,550.	APRIL 20-24 US aircraft target Haiphong harbor and attack North Vietnamese airfields for the first time in a significant escalation of the air war.	APRIL 24-MAY 11 US Marines resolve North Vietnamese troops in a series of actions around the Marine combat base at Khe Sanh.	
MARCH 2 The sustained bombing of North Vietnam by US Air Force and Navy aircraft begins, in Operation Rolling Thunder (ORT), launched mainly from bases in Thailand.	APRIL 17 Student antiwar protesters demonstrate outside the White House.	AUGUST 18-24 US Marines launch a strike against the Viet Cong in Operation Starline, the first major offensive operation by US ground forces in Vietnam.	DECEMBER 31 At the year's end there are 181,000 American troops in Vietnam. The American death toll for the year totals 1,922.		JAN 28-MAR 6 US, Korean, and ARVN troops carry out a "search-and-destroy" operation in Binh Dinh province.	SEPT 14-NOV 24 In Operation Abolition, the US 196th Light Infantry Brigade operations search-and-destroy units through Viet Cong base areas in Tay Ninh province, bordering Cambodia.	DECEMBER 31 At the year end there are 288,400 US troops in Vietnam. The US death toll for 1966 is 6,550.	APRIL 20-24 US aircraft target Haiphong harbor and attack North Vietnamese airfields for the first time in a significant escalation of the air war.
	APRIL 24-MAY 11 US Marines resolve North Vietnamese troops in a series of actions around the Marine combat base at Khe Sanh.	JULY 6 The North Vietnamese politburo adopts a plan for a "General Offensive and Uprising" in South Vietnam, with attacks on border areas to be followed by attacks in cities which will become the "Red Offensive".	JULY 29 An accidental fire aboard the carrier USS Forrestal in the Gulf of Tonkin kills 134 US citizens.		JAN 28-MAR 6 US, Korean, and ARVN troops carry out a "search-and-destroy" operation in Binh Dinh province.	SEPT 14-NOV 24 In Operation Abolition, the US 196th Light Infantry Brigade operations search-and-destroy units through Viet Cong base areas in Tay Ninh province, bordering Cambodia.	DECEMBER 31 At the year end there are 288,400 US troops in Vietnam. The US death toll for 1966 is 6,550.	APRIL 20-24 US aircraft target Haiphong harbor and attack North Vietnamese airfields for the first time in a significant escalation of the air war.
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